
CR Reference	CR-SMRC-0001
Project	Smart Round Clinic Telemedicine Platform
Client	Smart Round Clinic Ltd
Prepared By	Mini Root
Date Raised	31/07/2026
Change type	Feature addition (new functional module)
Status	Draft — pending client review and sign-off
Related documents	Platform Overview; Doctor SLA; Privacy Policy v2

1. Purpose

This Change Request proposes two related features for the Smart Round Clinic platform: a doctor-to-doctor referral workflow and a doctor-to-doctor chat capability. Together these allow a treating doctor to hand a patient's care off to another doctor and to connect directly with colleagues on the platform closing a gap in the current platform, which supports only direct, independent patient-to-doctor appointments.

2. Background

The current platform supports patients booking and completing appointments with individual doctors. There is no mechanism today for one doctor to bring a second doctor into a case, or for doctors to communicate with each other directly on the platform. As the doctor roster grows, this becomes a recurring need; a doctor identifying that a patient needs a different specialist, or doctors wanting to connect professionally without going through a patient.

3. Scope of Change

3.1 In scope

- **Doctor-to-doctor chat:** the existing Chat area on the doctor side gains two tabs Consultations and Services mirroring the tab pattern already used under Bookings.
- **Referral routing:** a doctor can refer a patient to another doctor, gated on having first marked the appointment complete and submitted the client rating, medical summary and prescription.
- A referral search/select flow so the referring doctor can find and choose the specific receiving doctor.
- Referral **tagging**, patient notification, and status tracking (Pending → Accepted) across doctor, patient and admin views.
- **Patient-side Referrals tab** (replacing the current Payments tab under Bookings), with Payments relocated to Profile, below medical history.
- Doctor-side renaming of Upcoming to Appointments, and replacement of Past with a Referrals tab.
- **Message content covering:** Doctors can exchange free-text messages and attach platform-held documents relevant to the shared case.
- **Admin-side visibility** of referral tag and status on appointments, plus referral volume and acceptance-rate stats on the admin dashboard.

3.2 Out of scope for this change

- Group/multi-doctor conferencing (more than two doctors in one thread).
- Video or voice calling between doctors this covers text chat and document attachments only.
- Cross-clinic or external-doctor referrals (referring to a doctor outside the platform).
- Changes to the commission/payout model referred appointments follow the existing Doctor SLA earnings and payout terms.

4. Business Justification

Referral and doctor-to-doctor chat close a real continuity-of-care gap: without them, a doctor who identifies that a patient needs different or specialist input has no way to act on that within the platform. Adding this workflow also gives doctors a reason to use Smart Round Clinic as a working environment, not just a booking channel and converts identified referral needs directly into bookings rather than losing that patient to drop-off.

5. Detailed Functional Requirements

5.1 Feature A — Doctor Referral

5.1.1 Referral eligibility

- A doctor can only refer a patient after marking the appointment complete and submitting the post-appointment client rating, medical summary, and prescription. Once these are saved, a **Refer** CTA appears on that appointment.

5.1.2 Initiating a referral

- Tapping **Refer** on a completed appointment prompts the doctor for a medical reason for the referral. From there, the doctor is taken to a search/browse screen structured around services, same as the existing doctor-list-by-service view to find and select the specific doctor they're referring the patient to. The doctor selects the receiving colleague and taps Confirm to complete the referral. On confirmation, the **system tags** that appointment as a referral and sends a notification to the patient.

5.1.3 Patient-side referral handling

- The patient's Bookings area currently has two tabs: Bookings and Payments. Payments moves to the Profile section, just below medical history and its place under Bookings is taken by a new Referrals tab. New referral requests appear here in a bookings-style list, each with a status of **Pending** until the patient acts, and an **Accept** CTA. Accepting takes the patient to the specific doctor's profile to proceed with booking the referral status changes from Pending to Accepted, and the request moves from the Referrals tab into the patient's Appointments, still carrying the referral tag.

5.1.4 Doctor-side referral handling

- Under the doctor's Bookings, the existing Upcoming tab is renamed Appointments, and the existing Past tab is replaced with a Referrals tab, showing booked appointments carrying the referral tag. Once the patient confirms the appointment, it moves into Appointments as a normal appointment, retaining the referral tag.

5.2 Feature B: Doctor-to-Doctor Messaging

5.2.1 Chat structure

The doctor-side Chat area gains two tabs, matching the existing Bookings tab pattern:

- **Consultations:** existing chats as-is, plus all new chats with patients and doctors.
- **Services:** reuses the existing patient-side Services view. The Specialty tab within this view is hidden for doctors.

5.2.2 Starting a chat with another doctor

- From the Services tab, a doctor selects a service and sees the list of available doctors for it, same as the patient-side flow. From there they can view that doctor's profile and tap Connect (in place of the patient-side Book Now). Tapping Connect opens a new chat window, which appears under the Consultations tab alongside existing chats.

5.2.3 Message capabilities

- Doctors can exchange free-text messages and attach documents.

5.2.4 Privacy

- Messages are private between the two doctors in the thread; platform admins do not have access to message content, consistent with the platform's existing privacy model (no admin access to chats or calls).

5.3 Admin Visibility

5.3.1 Appointments view

- On the admin side, the Appointments view shows all appointments as today. For any appointment linked to a referral, admin additionally sees the referral tag and its current status (Pending or Accepted).

5.3.2 Dashboard stats

- The admin dashboard gains referral stats: total number of referrals, and number accepted used to calculate an acceptance rate.

6. Documentation & Agreement Updates

This change touches how patient information and platform relationships work, and requires updates to the following existing documents before go-live:

- **Terms & Conditions:** updated to describe the referral workflow and doctor-to-doctor chat as platform features.
- **Doctor's Agreement:** updated to set expectations for doctors using referral and chat, including professional conduct in doctor-to-doctor communication.
- **Privacy Policy:** updated to describe the referral notification and data hand-off to a receiving doctor, and to confirm that doctor-to-doctor chat content is not accessible to platform admins.

7. Technical Impact

7.1 Data model

- New collections/records for referrals (referring doctor, receiving doctor, patient, reason, status, timestamps) and doctor chat threads.
- Extension of the existing appointment record to carry a referral tag.

7.2 Application layer

- **Doctor-side:** Chat area split into Consultations/Services tabs; Refer CTA and referral search/select flow on completed appointments; Bookings renamed to Appointments with Past replaced by Referrals.
- **Patient-side:** new Referrals tab under Bookings; Payments relocated to Profile.
- **Admin-side:** referral tag and status on appointments; referral stats on dashboard.

7.3 Integration with existing systems

- No changes required to IntaSend payment integration.
- No changes required to authentication (existing email-OTP flow applies unchanged).

8. Assumptions & Dependencies

- Both features are for verified, platform-onboarded doctors only; no external or pending-verification doctors can send or receive referrals/messages.
- The Terms & Conditions, Doctor's Agreement, and Privacy Policy updates in Section 6 are treated as a dependency of go-live, not of development build can proceed in parallel.
- No change is assumed to the commission/payout structure; referred appointments are billed and paid identically to direct-booked appointments.



9. Timeline

Estimated delivery: 2 weeks from receipt of deposit. This covers the referral workflow, doctor-to-doctor chat and associated notifications, UI, and admin dashboard changes.